

MINUTES OF MEETING HELD August 6th 2025 OF GRADUATE AND PROFESSIONAL STUDENT COUNCIL, EXECUTIVE BOARD

A meeting of the Graduate and Professional Student Council (GPSC), Executive Board (EB) was convened on Wednesday, August 6th at 2:00 PM held on Main Library #B254 and Zoom.

1. Call to Order

Time meeting begins: 2:17pm

Roll call: Mourad Abdennebi, Naama Levy, Travis Dean, Mehrdad Aghayari, Milad Hasankhani, Rishabh Bhattad, Roselyn, Amamoo, Solange Quintana, Elham Chalebi

- President: Mourad Abdennebi
- Executive: Travis Dean
- Vice President: Naama Levy
- Assembly Chair: Mehrdad Aghayari
- Treasurer: Milad Hasankhani
- Secretary: Rishabh Bhattad
- Grants & Funding Director: Roselyn Amamoo
- Policy & Institute Director: Elham Chelabi
- Communications Director: Solange Quintana

2. Call to Audience

The EB may not discuss items that are not on the agenda. Therefore, action taken as a result of public comment will be limited to directing staff to study the matter or scheduling the matter for consideration at a later date.

3. Review and Approve Meeting Minutes

The minutes from the previous meeting (June 17, 2025) were reviewed. It was noted that only Mourad Abdennebi, Travis Dean and Naama Levy were present at that meeting. The minutes were seconded by Elham.

4. Officer & Directors Roles & Expectations

- Welcome and clarify roles of GPSC officers Assembly Chair, Treasurer, and Secretary
- Welcome and clarify roles of GPSC directors Grants & Funding Director, Policy & Institute Director, Communications Director

5. Officer Reports

- President:

- **Meetings with Leadership:** Has held successful meetings with the university President, Provost, CFO, and directors of various departments (Rec Center, CAPS, Parking & Transportation)
- **Stipend Increase:** The provost has approved opening conversations for a potential 5% stipend increase next academic year.
- **International Student Hardship Grant:** University leadership is supportive of creating a new hardship grant for international students. A formal proposal is the next step.
- **Healthcare:** The Director of CAPS is agreeable to pursuing no-cost counseling for graduate students. The possibility of using a third-party provider for affordable dental and vision services was discussed.
- **Campus Pantry:** The Basic Needs Center will increase hours of distribution for all students as a compromise to the proposal for graduate-student-only hours.
- **Parking:** The Director of Parking and Transportation is willing to negotiate reduced parking permit prices for graduate students.
- **Cultural Resource Centers (CRCs):** The Provost will meet with graduate students on September 22nd to discuss the new "Cultural Hub" administrative structure. The core functions, programs, and physical locations of the CRCs will remain.
- **Campus Safety:** A new emergency reporting app is being tested. The need for better lighting on campus at night was raised.

- Vice President:

- Planning for the Representative Retreat is underway.
- Will create and distribute surveys regarding student funding experiences and satisfaction with advisors.
- GPSC will have a table and give a brief presentation at the upcoming "Disorientation" event hosted by the United Campus Workers union.

- Executive Vice President:

- Two separate listservs are now active: one for internal GPSC communication and one for the entire graduate student body.
- Will circulate a Google Sheet for General Council members to sign up for internal and external committees. The deadline for sign-ups is August 12th.

5. New Business & Action Items

- Meeting Schedule:

- Executive Board (EB) meetings will be held on the first Monday of every month with a hybrid format available.
- General Council (GC) meetings will be held on the third Monday of every month at 6:00 PM, with a hybrid format available.

- P-Card Usage: All board members must complete the official P-Card training in Edge before using the card.

- Pop-Up Pantry: An MOU has been signed to place a pop-up pantry in the GPSC house. Logistics for delivery and maintenance are being planned.

- Social Events: The Director of Communications will begin brainstorming ideas for a welcome event and other social gatherings for the semester.

6. Motion to Adjourn

- Motion to adjourn the meeting by President:

- Seconded by Elham
- The meeting was adjourned at 4:07 pm.

Dated this 6th day of August 2025

Graduate and Professional Student Council Executive Board

Rishabh Bhattad, Secretary